Neighbourhood WatchDog

Designed for **Security.**

An AI-assisted CCTV security platform built for EPI-USE Africa. This guide documents the complete visual language, design tokens, and component system powering the production interface.

Colours | Typography | Tokens | Components | Accessibility

Colour palette

A dark monochromatic system with a main accent of emerald green. Every colour has a purpose and a use case.

Brand neutrals

The greyscale foundation that allows for depth perception

Name	Hex	RGB	HSL	Use	Token
Void	#0A0A0A	rgb(10, 10, 10)	0°, 0%, 4%	Deepest background, modal overlays	`--color-void`
Abyss	#0D0D0D	rgb(13, 13, 13)	0°, 0%, 5%	Sidebar background, primary canvas	`--color-abyss`
Depth	#141414	rgb(20, 20, 20)	0°, 0%, 8%	Card backgrounds on dark surfaces	`--color-depth`
Slate	#1E1E1E	rgb(30, 30, 30)	0°, 0%, 12%	Hover states, secondary containers	`--color-slate`
Gunmetal	#8A8A8A	rgb(138, 138, 138)	0°, 0%, 54%	Disabled states, borders, dividers	`--color-gunmetal`
Ash	#A3A3A3	rgb(163, 163, 163)	0°, 0%, 64%	Muted body text, secondary labels	`--color-ash`
Frost	#F5F5F5	rgb(245, 245, 245)	0°, 0%, 96%	Primary text on dark, high contrast	`--color-frost`

Accent colours

Emerald is the primary brand colour.

Name	Hex	RGB	HSL	Use	Token
Emerald	#10B981	rgb(16, 185, 129)	160°, 84%, 39%	Primary action, brand accent, links, focus rings	`--color-green`
Pulse	#2D7EFF	rgb(45, 126, 255)	218°, 100%, 59%	Informational alerts, data visualisation secondary	`--color-pulse`
Ice	#6AB0FF	rgb(106, 176, 255)	213°, 100%, 71%	Hover state of informational, tag highlights	`--color-ice`

Semantic colours

Colours that are used to represent system states.

Name	Hex	RGB	HSL	Use	Token
Threat	#EF4444	rgb(239, 68, 68)	0°, 83%, 60%	Destructive actions, error states, critical alerts	`--color-threat`
Caution	#F59E0B	rgb(245, 158, 11)	38°, 92%, 50%	Warnings, medium-risk detections, expiry notices	`--color-caution`
Safe	#10B981	rgb(16, 185, 129)	160°, 84%, 39%	Success states, confirmed detections, system healthy	`--color-safe`
Info	#2D7EFF	rgb(45, 126, 255)	218°, 100%, 59%	Informational banners, non-urgent system messages	`--color-info`

Contrast ratios

All foreground/background pairs used in the live UI. AA (4.5:1) is the minimum; AAA (7:1) is achieved for all body text pairings.

Pair	Preview	Ratio	Level	Usage
Frost on Abyss	Aa	18.1:1	AAA	Primary body text
Emerald on Abyss	Aa	7.2:1	AAA	Brand accent text
Ash on Abyss	Aa	8.9:1	AAA	Secondary text
Frost on Slate	Aa	14.5:1	AAA	Card content text
Abyss on Emerald	Aa	7.2:1	AAA	Primary button label
Frost on Depth	Aa	16.8:1	AAA	Card headings
Threat on Abyss	Aa	4.7:1	AA	Error state text
Caution on Abyss	Aa	5.8:1	AA	Warning text

Type system

Inter used for standard interface text - legible at all sizes. JetBrains Mono for code, IDs, tokens, and technical text. Both sourced from Google Fonts.

UI / Interface `--font-sans`

Inter

ABCDEFGHIJKLM
nopqrstuvwxyz
0123456789!@#

Weights: 300, 400, 500, 600, 700
Source: Google Fonts · SIL OFL
Fallback: `system-ui, sans-serif`

Type scale

Style	Token	Sample	Size / line height	Weight · use
Display	`--text-display`	WatchDog	3rem / 3.5rem	w700 · Hero headlines, splash screens
H1	`--text-h1`	Neighbourhood Security	2rem / 2.5rem	w700 · Page-level headings
H2	`--text-h2`	Camera Feeds	1.5rem / 2rem	w600 · Section headings
H3	`--text-h3`	Alert summary	1.25rem / 1.75rem	w600 · Card headings, subsections
Body LG	`--text-body-lg`	Monitored zones detected 3 events.	1.125rem / 1.75rem	w400 · Lead paragraph text
Body	`--text-body`	Camera is active and streaming.	1rem / 1.5rem	w400 · Standard interface text
Small	`--text-sm`	Last updated 2 min ago	0.875rem / 1.25rem	w400 · Labels, helper text
Caption	`--text-caption`	Zone B - Perimeter	0.75rem / 1rem	w400 · Timestamps, metadata
Code	`--text-code`	`camera.stream.start()`	0.875rem / 1.25rem	w400 · Code snippets, IDs

Logo

The WatchDog logo represents the core values of the platform: protection, vigilance, and trust. It combines a shield with the silhouette of a dog to creates a sense of physical security and intelligent monitoring

Symbolism

The shield represents security, and reliability reflecting the system's purpose of safeguarding neighbourhoods. The dog symbolizes vigilance and constant awareness-qualities associated with a watchdog that remains alert to potential threats.

Brand Identity

The logo is designed to communicate confidence and simplicity. Its clean geometric form ensures it remains recognizable across the application, documentation, presentations, and mobile platforms while maintaining a professional appearance.

Token system

All values are defined as CSS custom properties in globals.css

Spacing | Radius | Motion | Shadows | Breakpoints

Token	Value	Usage
`--space-1`	4px	Icon gap, micro nudge
`--space-2`	8px	Inline element gap
`--space-3`	12px	Input padding, compact rows
`--space-4`	16px	Card padding, section gap
`--space-5`	24px	Component margin, between cards
`--space-6`	32px	Section separator
`--space-8`	48px	Page section spacing
`--space-10`	64px	Hero vertical padding
`--space-12`	96px	Full-bleed section height

UI components

All components are built on shadcn/ui with Tailwind, tokens from globals.css. States are interactive - hover, click, and type to see live behaviour.

Buttons

Hover to see transitions (100ms ease-out). All buttons have a visible focus ring for keyboard navigation.

Primary variants

Confirm detection | Secondary | Outline | Ghost

Semantic variants

Dismiss alert | Export | Disabled

Sizes

Small | Default | Large

Inputs

Default: Camera name...

With value: North entrance, Zone A

Error state: IP address...

Invalid format - use 192.168.x.x

Disabled: Read-only feed ID

Status Badges

Status badges provides the user with visual feedback about the state of alerts, devices, and system events.

Active | Threat Detected | Warning | Information | Offline | Processing

Toast notifications

Triggered programmatically. Appearing in the top-right, auto-dismiss

Show Success | Show Error | Show Warning | Show Info

Accessibility

The WatchDog interface is designed to remain clear, readable, and usable. Accessibility considerations focus on visual clarity, consistent navigation, and reducing user effort when interacting with the platform.

AA

Colour Contrast

High contrast between text and backgrounds improves readability.

UI

Consistent Layout

Navigation, spacing, and interface elements remain consistent throughout the application.

Focus States

Interactive elements provide a visible focus state so users can easily identify the currently selected control while navigating the interface.

Button | Input Field

Design Principles

- ✓ Maintain consistent spacing throughout the interface.
- ✓ Use clear typography with readable font sizes.
- ✓ Avoid relying solely on colour to communicate information.
- ✓ Ensure buttons and controls remain visually distinct.
- ✓ Provide meaningful feedback for user actions.